

D033

Healthcare Information Systems Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 300-bed community hospital's strategy is to grow outpatient cardiology in rural counties. The IT director, who recently attended a major tech conference, proposes a robotic pharmacy system. Which proposal best reflects strategic alignment?

- A. Whatever technology other hospitals are buying.
- B. A telehealth and remote cardiac monitoring platform for rural patients.
- C. The robotic pharmacy system, because it is advanced.
- D. Delay all IT spending until strategy is perfect.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

Five departments submit IT projects totaling \$6 million against a \$2 million budget. The surgery chief is the most vocal and has the largest department. What is the best governance approach?

- A. A steering committee scores projects against strategic goals and value, then funds the top ones.
- B. Let IT staff choose based on technical interest.
- C. Fund surgery's project first because it is the largest department.
- D. Split the \$2 million evenly across all five.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A patient uses a phone app that she controls to track her blood pressure, medications, and allergies and shares it with any clinician she chooses. The app has a five-star rating. What is this record?

- A. An electronic health record (EHR).
- B. Not a health record, because it has no clinician.
- C. An electronic medical record (EMR).
- D. A personal health record (PHR).

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A clinic's digital chart can be viewed and updated by the hospital, the specialist, and the pharmacy the patient uses. What term best fits?

- A.** Health information exchange.
- B.** Electronic medical record (EMR).
- C.** Personal health record (PHR).
- D.** Electronic health record (EHR).

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A health system with a new logo requires annual privacy training for all staff and completes a yearly risk analysis. It also uses badge readers on server rooms. Which safeguard category do the training and risk analysis fall into?

- A.** Physical safeguards, because of the badge readers.
- B.** Administrative safeguards.
- C.** Technical safeguards.
- D.** None; training is optional.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A clinic estimates that a data-loss event would cost \$200,000 each time and is expected once every four years. The clinic has 12 providers and a new website. What is the annualized loss expectancy?

- A.** \$50,000
- B.** \$200,004
- C.** \$800,000
- D.** \$200,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A risk has an ALE of \$30,000 and an SLE of \$120,000. How often is it expected to occur?

- A.** Once a year.
- B.** Four times a year.
- C.** Once every four years (ARO 0.25).
- D.** \$150,000 a year.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A hospital compares two scheduling systems. System A: \$300,000 license, \$150,000 implementation, \$50,000 training, \$60,000 a year maintenance for five years. System B costs \$450,000 up front with all costs included for five years and has a sleek interface. What is System A's five-year TCO?

- A. \$560,000
- B. \$300,000
- C. \$800,000
- D. \$450,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A system's five-year TCO is \$700,000. It includes a \$100,000 license, \$200,000 implementation, and equal yearly maintenance. What is the yearly maintenance?

- A. \$400,000
- B. \$80,000
- C. \$120,000
- D. \$140,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A clinic subscribes to a cloud-based scheduling application. The vendor hosts, updates, and patches the software; clinic staff only log in and use it. The vendor is based in another state. Which model is this?

- A. Software as a service (SaaS).
- B. Platform as a service (PaaS).
- C. Infrastructure as a service (IaaS).
- D. On-premises hosting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A hospital with a new emergency wing decides its EHR must be back online within 4 hours of an outage and lose no more than 15 minutes of data. The disaster plan was approved by the board last year. Which figure is the RPO?

- A.** One year, the plan's approval cycle.
- B.** 4 hours.
- C.** 4 hours 15 minutes.
- D.** 15 minutes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A lab system is backed up every hour. If the business can tolerate losing at most 30 minutes of data, what should change?

- A.** Back up once a day to reduce cost.
- B.** Shorten the recovery time objective.
- C.** Back up at least every 30 minutes.
- D.** Nothing; hourly backups meet a 30-minute RPO.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A 300-bed community hospital's strategy is to grow outpatient cardiology in rural counties. The IT director, ~~who recently attended a major tech conference,~~ proposes a robotic pharmacy system. Which proposal best reflects strategic alignment?

Target word: aligned investment **Decides:** Strategy = rural outpatient cardiology growth.

A	Adjacent category	Imitation is not alignment with this strategy.
B	Correct	Directly enables the stated strategy.
C	Camouflage	Advanced technology is not the same as alignment.
D	Absolute language	Strategy exists; waiting is not required.

2. Answer A Concept 2

Five departments submit IT projects totaling \$6 million against a \$2 million budget. ~~The surgery chief is the most vocal and has the largest department.~~ What is the best governance approach?

Target word: prioritization approach **Decides:** Structured prioritization against strategy.

A	Correct	Governance sets decision rights and criteria.
B	Adjacent category	IT alone lacks business decision rights.
C	Camouflage	Size and volume do not decide priority.
D	Dropped element	Ignores value and strategy in allocation.

3. Answer D Concept 3

A patient uses a phone app that she controls to track her blood pressure, medications, and allergies and shares it with any clinician she chooses. ~~The app has a five-star rating.~~ What is this record?

Target word: record type **Decides:** Managed by the patient.

A	Confusion set	EHRs are maintained by providers across organizations.
B	Absolute language	PHRs are patient-managed by definition.
C	Adjacent category	A single organization's chart.
D	Correct	Patient-controlled record.

4. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

A clinic's digital chart can be viewed and updated by the hospital, the specialist, and the pharmacy the patient uses. What term best fits?

Target word: record type **Decides:** Shared across organizations.

A	Adjacent category	The network that moves data, not the record itself.
B	Confusion set	Stays within one organization.
C	Inverted operation	Controlled by the patient, not providers.
D	Correct	Follows the patient across organizations.

5. Answer B Concept 4

A health system ~~with a new logo~~ requires annual privacy training for all staff and completes a yearly risk analysis. ~~It also uses badge readers on server rooms.~~ Which safeguard category do the training and risk analysis fall into?

Target word: safeguard category **Decides:** Policies, training, risk analysis.

A	Camouflage	The badge readers are physical; training and risk analysis are not.
B	Correct	Policies, training, and risk analysis are administrative.
C	Confusion set	Technical covers system controls like access control and audit logs.
D	Absolute language	Training is an expected administrative safeguard.

6. Answer A Concept 5

A clinic estimates that a data-loss event would cost \$200,000 each time and is expected once every four years. ~~The clinic has 12 providers and a new website.~~ What is the annualized loss expectancy?

Target word: ALE **Decides:** $SLE \times ARO = 200,000 \times 0.25$.

A	Correct	$\$200,000 \times 0.25 = \$50,000$.
B	Confusion set	Adds instead of multiplying.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies by 4 instead of by 1/4.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out the annual rate.

7. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A risk has an ALE of \$30,000 and an SLE of \$120,000. How often is it expected to occur?

Target word: solve for ARO **Decides:** $ARO = ALE / SLE$.

A	Dropped element	Assumes $ARO = 1$.
B	Inverted operation	Inverts the ratio.
C	Correct	$30,000 / 120,000 = 0.25$.
D	Confusion set	Adds ALE and SLE, which gives a dollar amount, not a frequency.

8. Answer C Concept 6

A hospital compares two scheduling systems. System A: \$300,000 license, \$150,000 implementation, \$50,000 training, \$60,000 a year maintenance for five years. System B costs \$450,000 up front with all costs included for five years ~~and has a sleek interface~~. What is System A's five-year TCO?

Target word: TCO for A **Decides:** Sum all costs over five years.

A	Wrong stem number	Counts one year of maintenance only.
B	Dropped element	License price only.
C	Correct	$300 + 150 + 50 + (60 \times 5 = 300) = \$800,000$.
D	Camouflage	System B's price; the interface does not decide A's TCO.

9. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

A system's five-year TCO is \$700,000. It includes a \$100,000 license, \$200,000 implementation, and equal yearly maintenance. What is the yearly maintenance?

Target word: solve for maintenance **Decides:** $(700,000 - 300,000) / 5$.

A	Wrong stem number	Total maintenance over five years, not per year.
B	Correct	$\$400,000 \text{ remaining} / 5 \text{ years} = \$80,000$.
C	Dropped element	Subtracts only the license and drops the implementation cost.
D	Adjacent category	Treats one-time license and implementation costs as recurring yearly costs.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A clinic subscribes to a cloud-based scheduling application. The vendor hosts, updates, and patches the software; clinic staff only log in and use it. ~~The vendor is based in another state.~~ Which model is this?

Target word: cloud model **Decides:** Vendor manages the application.

A	Correct	Vendor runs the full application stack.
B	Confusion set	The customer would build and manage its own apps.
C	Inverted operation	The customer would manage the OS and application.
D	Adjacent category	The software is not on the clinic's own servers.

11. Answer D Concept 8

A hospital ~~with a new emergency wing~~ decides its EHR must be back online within 4 hours of an outage and lose no more than 15 minutes of data. ~~The disaster plan was approved by the board last year.~~ Which figure is the RPO?

Target word: identify RPO **Decides:** Maximum acceptable data loss.

A	Camouflage	The approval date is not a recovery objective.
B	Confusion set	That is the RTO, maximum downtime.
C	Inverted operation	Adds two different measures.
D	Correct	RPO measures tolerable data loss in time.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

A lab system is backed up every hour. If the business can tolerate losing at most 30 minutes of data, what should change?

Target word: match backup to RPO **Decides:** Backup interval must not exceed RPO.

A	Adjacent category	Worsens data loss far beyond the RPO.
B	Confusion set	RTO is downtime, not data loss.
C	Correct	The backup interval must meet the RPO.
D	Inverted operation	An hour of possible loss exceeds 30 minutes.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Strategic alignment	IT investments should follow and enable the organization's strategy, not drive it.	Choosing technology first and then looking for a strategic reason.	A tech purchase proposed without reference to organizational goals.
2	IT governance	IT governance sets decision rights and a process (often a steering committee) to prioritize projects against strategy and value.	Letting the loudest department or the IT staff alone set priorities.	Competing project requests with limited funds.
3	EMR vs. EHR vs. PHR	An EMR is one organization's digital chart; an EHR is shared across organizations and follows the patient; a PHR is managed by the patient.	Using EMR and EHR as the same thing, or calling a patient-kept record an EHR.	Who controls the record and whether it crosses organizations.
4	HIPAA Security Rule safeguards	Safeguards are administrative (policies, risk analysis, training), physical (facility and device access), and technical (access control, audit logs, encryption).	Filing staff training as a technical safeguard.	Classify a control by whether it is policy, physical, or system-based.
5	Risk quantification	Annualized loss expectancy (ALE) = single loss expectancy (SLE) × annual rate of occurrence (ARO); controls are justified when they cost less than the risk they reduce.	Adding SLE and ARO or ignoring frequency.	A loss per event and an expected frequency per year.
6	Total cost of ownership	TCO adds purchase, implementation, training, maintenance, and support over the system's life, not just the license price.	Comparing systems by purchase price alone.	Multi-year costs listed next to an up-front price.
7	Cloud service models	SaaS: vendor runs the application and everything under it; PaaS: vendor runs the platform, customer builds apps; IaaS: vendor provides infrastructure, customer manages OS and up.	Assuming the customer patches the application in SaaS.	Who manages the application, operating system, and hardware.
8	RTO vs. RPO	Recovery time objective is how long a system can be down; recovery point objective is how much data (measured in time) can be lost.	Swapping the two.	"Back up and running within..." vs. "lose no more than ... of data."

Course scope (public description): Healthcare Information Systems Management provides an overview of many facets of information systems in healthcare. This course explores how information technology (IT) is an organizational resource that must be managed so that it supports or enables healthcare organizational strategy. This course will discuss how decision support and communication are securely facilitated in the healthcare marketplace. This course also explores current and continuously evolving technologies, strategic thinking, and issues at the intersection of health information management and technology.